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Quality Sales Leads



By **Chaz Wilke**, Staff Writer

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The wide availability of sales leads on the Internet requires a qualification process to weed out the leads worth your time. Before the Internet, salespeople would spend a great deal of time with each lead since those leads were few and far between. Now the reach of the Internet has created a much larger audience and therefore a larger availability of leads. But not all that are available would be considered quality sales leads. It is up to you, the affiliate marketer, to decipher which are quality sales leads and which are not worth your time.

The Importance of Qualified Sales Leads

It may be appetizing to jump on every sales lead that comes through your lead generation efforts. You may want to jam it through the sales funnel without considering if it is a quality sales lead or not. You might hope that it converts into becoming your advertiser's customer and maybe making you some commission.

This is not advised.

Part of the Internet lead generation process requires you to understand that some of these leads may ultimately hurt your efforts. Your job as an affiliate marketer is to only push quality sales leads through the conversion funnel. Your advertiser is paying you to do this. If you skip qualifying sales leads before sending them on, you may damage your reputation to both your advertiser and your affiliate marketing network.

Qualifying Sales Leads



- **Ask the right questions the right way**

Even phrasing the right questions the wrong way can give you bad leads. It is important to not get too

invasive with your questions. Remember, a prospect has no reason to trust you or hand over sensitive personal information to you right away. So while it may seem correct to ask specifics about a prospect's personal finances, an invasively worded question may lead to prospect's lying on your lead generation form.

- **Focus on your niche**

Knowing your audience as well as the products or services you promote helps attract quality sales leads from the start. If you appear knowledgeable on your niche, you'll attract a knowledgeable following. Much of the filtering during the qualification process can be done by presenting thoughtful and knowledgeable content on your site.

Declan Dunn, a self-described Entrepreneur, online educator, and gonzo community developer, explains his methodologies for finding quality sales leads:

Missing Plug-in ➔

FAINT Data

Funds, Authority, Interest, Need and **Timing** help qualify a sales lead with actionable data much more so than just acquiring a sales lead's name and contact information. Depending on your niche, especially if you are doing B2C affiliate marketing, some of these criteria may be more important than other.

FAINT has replaced **BANT** as the [preferred acronym](#) in qualifying sales leads. The key reason for the switch is **BANT** (**B**udget, **A**uthority, **N**eed, and **T**iming) doesn't address interest and operates under the assumption that every lead has a budget assigned for your product or service. Both B2B and B2C can comfortably operate within the FAINT acronym's framework. If interest is high enough and you do your job expressing the value of your product or service, then the qualified lead may present itself with the funds necessary to convert.

It is important to frame your lead generation capture form questions using **FAINT** as your guide. This will help capture the most qualified sales leads with minimized false positives.

Using Content to Find Qualified Sales Leads



A qualified sales lead may be deceptively hard to find at first. But with patience and a few unconventional tactics, like using content to drive your lead generation efforts, you may find your qualified sales lead numbers steadily climb.

Seth Lieberman, the CEO of SnapApp, pulled together a few statistics that show the true benefit of interactive content used to find qualified sales leads. In the end, traffic and visitors are important, but engaged visitors are those that become qualified sales leads. "More engaging, targeted content brings more leads in, pushes more leads through the funnel and drives better outcomes," Lieberman adds.

Consider adding interactive quizzes like personality tests, polls and even puzzle games to attract engaged visitors and potentially acquire their information as a qualified sales lead in the process.

In a recent interview, Lieberman stated a few impressive stats with regards to the use of interactive content:

- Click rates become higher than 50%
- Lead-form completion rates become higher than 80%
- Share rates increase to higher than 20 percent.

Quality Sales Leads Takeaway

Quality sales leads can boost your affiliate marketing career to the next level. Seeking qualified sales leads is how you go from struggling with affiliate marketing to excelling at it. Once you manage the basics of how to

find a qualified sales lead, then it is merely a matter of tweaking and iterating your process. Soon you may find yourself a master of qualifying sales leads.

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Chaz Wilke

Content Writer

Hailing from Chicago and a product of the Illinois public school system, Chaz Wilke is a professional writer who has written for newspaper, TV, radio, video games, blogs, and film. In his spare time, Chaz enjoys hiking and discovering the hidden gems and oddities of Los Angeles. He also juggles.

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D&D Marketing USA

4000 W. Alameda Ave, Suite 200

Burbank, CA 91505

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